

YEN-LIBERIA

BUSINESS PLAN GUIDE

A practical planning workbook for entrepreneurs and small business owners

PLAN

BUILD

GROW

Youth Entrepreneurs Network - Liberia
Business Resource Center

01

How to Use This Guide

Turn your business idea into a clear, practical plan

A business plan is a working document that explains what your business does, who it serves, how it operates, how it earns money, and what it needs to grow. It can help you make better decisions, communicate with partners, and prepare for financing or investment.

Keep it practical

Use real information from your business whenever possible. A shorter, accurate plan is more useful than a long plan built on guesses.

A complete business plan should answer these questions

- What problem does the business solve?
- Who are the target customers?
- What products or services will be sold?
- Why will customers choose this business instead of alternatives?
- How will the business reach and serve customers?
- What people, equipment, suppliers and systems are required?
- How much will it cost to operate, and how will the business earn a profit?
- What are the biggest risks and the next growth priorities?

Business plan checklist

Section	Complete?
Executive Summary	☐
Business Overview	☐
Market & Customer Analysis	☐
Marketing & Sales Plan	☐
Operations & Team	☐
Financial Plan	☐
Funding & Growth Plan	☐
Risks & Action Plan	☐

02

Executive Summary & Business Overview

Describe the business clearly and simply

Executive Summary

Write this section last, even though it appears first. Summarize the most important parts of the plan in one page or less.

- Business name and location
- Product or service
- Target customers
- Problem or customer need
- What makes the business different
- Current stage and key achievements
- Main financial or growth goal

In 4-6 sentences, explain what your business does and why it can succeed:

Business Overview

Planning question	Your answer
Business name	
Owner(s) / founder(s)	
Location / county	
Year started / planned start	
Industry / sector	
Legal status / registration	
Main products or services	

What customer problem or need does your business address?

What is your long-term vision for the business?

03

Market & Customer Analysis

Know who will buy, why they will buy, and who else serves them

Define your target customer

Avoid saying “everyone.” A strong business plan identifies the customer groups most likely to buy and explains their needs, location, purchasing habits and ability to pay.

Customer factor	Notes
Primary customer group	
Age / life stage (if relevant)	
Location	
Income / budget level	
Main need or problem	
How they currently solve it	
What influences their buying decision	

Competitor analysis

Competitor / alternative	Strength	Weakness	Your advantage

Evidence matters

Use customer conversations, sales records, observation, price checks and market research to support your assumptions.

Why will customers choose your business?

04

Marketing & Sales Plan

Explain how people will discover, trust and buy from the business

Your offer

Product / service	Customer benefit	Price	Estimated cost

Marketing channels

- Word of mouth and referrals
- WhatsApp and direct messaging
- Facebook, Instagram or other social platforms
- Physical signage, flyers or community promotion
- Partnerships, agents or resellers
- Events, markets, exhibitions and business networks
- Website, online marketplace or e-commerce channels

Which 2-3 channels are most likely to reach your customers, and why?

Simple monthly sales target

Item	Units per month	Selling price	Expected sales
TOTAL			

05

Operations, Team & Compliance

Show how the business will deliver consistently

Operations plan

Describe the daily activities required to deliver your product or service. Include suppliers, equipment, workspace, transportation, quality control, customer service and record keeping.

Operational area	What is required?
Suppliers / raw materials	
Equipment / tools	
Workspace / location	
Transport / delivery	
Technology / systems	
Quality control	
Customer service	

Team & responsibilities

Person / role	Main responsibility	Full-time / part-time

Formalization & compliance

- Business registration and ownership records
- Tax registration and relevant tax obligations
- Licenses, permits or sector approvals where required
- Basic contracts, invoices and receipts
- Employee records and workplace responsibilities
- Financial records and bookkeeping system

Check current requirements

Registration, tax and licensing requirements can change. Confirm the current rules with the appropriate Liberian authorities or qualified advisers.

Startup or expansion costs

Cost item	Estimated amount (USD/LRD)
Equipment / tools	
Initial inventory / materials	
Registration / permits	
Rent / deposit	
Branding / marketing	
Transport / logistics	
Working capital	
Other	
TOTAL	

Monthly operating forecast

Monthly item	Amount
Expected sales revenue	
Cost of goods / direct costs	
Rent	
Salaries / wages	
Utilities / internet	
Transport	
Marketing	
Loan repayment / finance cost	
Other expenses	
Estimated monthly profit	

Cash is different from profit

A business can show a profit on paper and still run short of cash. Track when money actually comes in and when bills must be paid.

Break-even thinking

Break-even is the point where total sales cover total costs. Estimate how many units, customers or contracts you need each month to cover your fixed and variable expenses.

Funding requirement

How much funding do you need, and what will the money be used for?

Use of funds	Amount	Expected result
TOTAL		

Growth priorities

- Increase customers or contracts
- Introduce new products or services
- Improve equipment or production capacity
- Hire and train staff
- Enter a new county or market
- Strengthen digital sales and marketing
- Improve financial records and business systems

Risk assessment

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation
	Low / Med / High	Low / Med / High	

Plan for uncertainty

Good business plans do not pretend risks do not exist. They show how the entrepreneur will reduce, monitor or respond to them.

08

90-Day Action Plan & Final Review

Turn the plan into measurable next steps

90-day action plan

Priority action	Deadline	Responsible person	Success measure

Final review checklist

- The business problem and customer are clearly defined.
- Products/services and prices are realistic.
- Sales assumptions are supported by evidence where possible.
- Major costs are included and totals have been checked.
- The plan explains how the business will operate day to day.
- Funding needs are specific and linked to clear business results.
- Key risks and practical responses are identified.
- The plan uses consistent numbers across all sections.
- Spelling, names, dates and contact details have been reviewed.

Update your plan

Review your business plan when prices, customers, products, staffing or business goals change. Treat it as a management tool, not a document you write once and forget.

Next step

Use the completed plan to guide decisions, discuss your business with mentors and partners, and prepare for appropriate financing opportunities. Keep supporting evidence such as registration documents, sales records, quotations, budgets and customer information organized.

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